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5 AI Roles You Can Become With the 12-Week RoadMap

Post-session reference guide: how the IntelliForge RoadMap maps to AI Engineer · ML Engineer · Agent Engineer · Voice AI Engineer · AI Product Engineer

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ABSTRACT

This document is the post-session research companion to the IntelliForge AI RoadMap Call (21 June 2026). It maps the 12-week programme curriculum to five high-demand AI engineering roles: AI Engineer, ML Engineer, Agent Engineer, Voice AI Engineer, and AI Product Engineer. For each role, it identifies the critical programme weeks, specific skills to prioritise, portfolio projects that create the strongest hiring signal, open-source contribution opportunities, and the salary range. Use this document to personalise your learning path through the bootcamp.

R1 AI Engineer RAG · Agents · MCP · Deployment	R2 ML Engineer Models · Pipelines · Evaluation
R3 Agent Engineer Tool orchestration · Memory · MCP	R4 Voice AI Engineer STT · TTS · Multimodal systems
R5 AI Product Engineer System design · UX · Scalability	



01

5 Roles · One RoadMap

The IntelliForge 12-Week RoadMap is not a single-track programme. Depending on which role you're targeting, certain weeks carry more weight than others. This guide maps every role to the exact weeks that build your hiring signal — so you know where to invest extra effort.

ID	ROLE	CORE SKILLS	SALARY RANGE	KEY WEEKS
R1	AI Engineer	RAG · Agents · MCP · Deployment	₹18–35 LPA	W01 W02 W03 W04 W05 W09 W10 W11
R2	ML Engineer	Models · Pipelines · Evaluation	₹20–45 LPA	W01 W02 W03 W04 W09 W10 W11
R3	Agent Engineer	Tool orchestration · Memory · MCP	₹22–50 LPA	W02 W05 W06 W09 W10 W11
R4	Voice AI Engineer	STT · TTS · Multimodal systems	₹18–40 LPA	W01 W02 W05 W06 W07 W11
R5	AI Product Engineer	System design · UX · Scalability	₹25–60 LPA	W01 W02 W07 W08 W09 W10 W11 W12

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Pick your target role. Read its page. Then revisit the 12-week curriculum with that role's week-weighting in mind. W01–W06 builds the common foundation. W07–W12 is where the paths diverge. The **portfolio projects** listed per role are the artefacts that get you the interview — not the certificate.

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Role Index

R1 AI Engineer RAG · Agents · MCP · Deployment	R2 ML Engineer Models · Pipelines · Evaluation
R3 Agent Engineer Tool orchestration · Memory · MCP	R4 Voice AI Engineer STT · TTS · Multimodal systems
R5 AI Product Engineer System design · UX · Scalability	

THE COMMON PRINCIPLE ACROSS ALL 5 ROLES

"Most people build chatbots. Builders build systems that solve expensive problems." — Every role listed here rewards engineers who ship real systems with quantified business impact. The portfolio project matters more than the certification. Always.

R1

AI Engineer

RAG · Agents · MCP · Deployment

₹18–35 LPA

Very High

Phase 1 — AI Foundations

Phase 2 — RAG & Data

Phase 3 — Agents

W01

W02

W03

W04

W05

W09

W10

W11

12-WEEK ROADMAP → AI ENGINEER		
WEEK	TOPIC	HOW IT BUILDS THIS ROLE
W01–W02	AI & LLM Foundations	Master Claude API, prompt engineering, structured outputs, eval harness. Core toolset for every AI Engineering...
W03–W04	RAG Systems	pgvector setup, chunking strategies, RAGAS evaluation. RAG is the #1 skill hiring managers test for AI Engineer...
W05–W06	Agent Design + Async	ReAct agents, tool calling, BullMQ queues. Portfolio P1 (Compliance Sentinel) and P2 (Code Reviewer) are direc...
W09–W10	Production + Security	Fly.io deployment, Prometheus observability, prompt injection defence. Separates junior from senior AI Engineer...
W11	Capstone	Ship a full AI product end-to-end. This is the GitHub link that gets you the interview.

SKILLS TO BUILD

→ Claude / GPT-4 API — tool calling, streaming, structured outputs

→ Supabase pgvector — HNSW indexing, hybrid search, RLS

→ LangGraph — multi-step agent state machines

→ BullMQ + Fly.io — async AI job infrastructure

→ RAGAS — RAG evaluation with faithfulness + relevancy metrics

→ Prompt injection defence + PII redaction middleware

PORTFOLIO PROJECTS

P1

Compliance Sentinel Agent

LangGraph + RAG + Fly.io — demonstrates full AI engineer stack

P2

Autonomous Code Reviewer

Multi-agent + LLM-as-judge — demonstrates agent orchestration

P3

Research-to-Deck Generator

RAG + python-pptx — demonstrates multi-doc retrieval pipeline

OSS CONTRIBUTIONS

○ LangGraph (langchain-ai/langgraph)

○ RAGAS (explodinggradients/ragas)

○ LiteLLM (BerriAI/litellm)

HIRING SIGNAL

A GitHub repo with a deployed RAG API + one agentic project with a Loom demo is the minimum bar for an AI Engineer role in 2026. Freshers with 2 deployed LLM projects on GitHub often out-earn IIT graduates with no projects (Instahyre 2026).

DEMAND SIGNAL

GenAI roles carry 20–40% premium over generalist AI roles (Scaler 2026)

MARKET INTELLIGENCE — INDIA 2026			
SALARY RANGES		MARKET SIGNALS	
Fresher	₹8–12 LPA	Growth	15–20% annually through 2030
Mid (3–7y)	₹20–45 LPA	Hirers	Google India, Microsoft, Amazon, Flipkart, Razorpay, Sa...
Senior	₹45–80 LPA+	Cities	Hyderabad offers best salary-to-cost ratio; Bengaluru h
Remote/US	₹60–80 LPA (remote, US-based companies)	Jobs	4,00,000+ active AI job openings on LinkedIn, Naukri, I
		Gap	Demand growing 40% YoY; qualified supply grows only 15–

RESEARCH SOURCES & LIVE JOB LINKS

Instahyre AI Salary Report India 2026

<https://resources.instahyre.com/blog/ai-engineer-salary-in-india/>

Taggd AI Engineer Salary Guide 2026

<https://taggd.in/blogs/ai-engineer-salary/>

Glassdoor — AI Engineer Bangalore

https://www.glassdoor.com/Salaries/bangalore-ai-engineer-salary-SRCH_IL_09_IM1091_KO10,21.htm

NASSCOM AI Jobs India 2026 (via Naukri)

<https://www.naukri.com/ai-engineer-jobs>

Scaler AI/ML Salary Complete Guide 2026

<https://www.scaler.com/topics/ai-ml-engineer-salary-complete-guide/>

R2

ML Engineer

Models · Pipelines · Evaluation

₹20–45 LPA

High

Phase 1 — Foundations

Phase 2 — RAG & Data

Phase 5 — Production

W01

W02

W03

W04

W09

W10

W11

12-WEEK ROADMAP → ML ENGINEER

WEEK	TOPIC	HOW IT BUILDS THIS ROLE
W01–W02	LLM Foundations + Evals	Transformer architecture (understand layer), fine-tuning concepts, RLHF. W02 eval harness directly maps to MLO...
W03–W04	Embeddings + Data Pipelines	Vector databases, chunking, hybrid retrieval. Core data engineering skills for ML pipelines.
W02	Structured Outputs + Zod	LLM-as-judge patterns, BLEU/ROUGE metrics. Foundation of ML model evaluation in production.
W09	Observability + Deployment	OpenTelemetry, Axiom logs, latency tracking. MLOps monitoring in production.
W10	Cost Governance	Semantic caching, model routing (Haiku→Sonnet→Opus). P5 Cost-Aware Router is an ML pipeline design project.

SKILLS TO BUILD

→ Transformer architecture — attention, positional encoding, tokenisation

→ Fine-tuning concepts — LoRA, PEFT (understand, not necessarily implement)

→ Embedding models — sentence-transformers, text-embedding-ada

→ RAGAS + LLM-as-judge — model evaluation in production

→ Prometheus + Grafana — ML model performance monitoring

→ Semantic caching — cost reduction in LLM inference pipelines

PORTFOLIO PROJECTS

P5Cost-Aware Agent Router

Token budgeting + model routing + Prometheus — core MLOps signal

P3Research-to-Deck Generator

Multi-document embedding pipeline — data engineering + RAG

W02 deliverableLLM Eval Harness

10-case eval with LLM-as-judge + BLEU/ROUGE metrics

OSS CONTRIBUTIONS

RAGAS (explodinggradients/ragas)

Instructor (jxn1/instructor)

Portkey Gateway (Portkey-AI/gateway)

HIRING SIGNAL

ML Engineers with LLM evaluation experience (RAGAS, LLM-as-judge, latency benchmarking) are commanding 40% premium over traditional ML Engineers in 2026.

DEMAND SIGNAL

GenAI avg ₹39.2 LPA; MLOps avg ₹28.4–38 LPA (Scaler 2026)

MARKET INTELLIGENCE — INDIA 2026

SALARY RANGES		MARKET SIGNALS	
Fresher	₹6–14 LPA (₹20–40 LPA at Sarvam AI, Krutrim)	Growth	GenAI + MLOps: 4× demand increase in recent years (IIT KGP data)
		Hirers	Sarvam AI (₹20–75 LPA), Krutrim, Microsoft India, Google...
Mid (3–7y)	₹25–50 LPA at product companies	Cities	Bengaluru + Hyderabad lead; FAANG India: ₹45–80 LPA tot
Senior	₹45–60 LPA (MLOps); ₹80 LPA+ (GenAI/LLM specialist)	Jobs	42,000+ AIML vacancies on Naukri alone (June 2026)
		Gap	MLOps engineers in severe shortage — AI systems need pr
Remote/US	MLOps + LLM skills: 30–50% salary jump over generalist ML		

RESEARCH SOURCES & LIVE JOB LINKS

IIT KGP AI/ML Engineer Salary India 2026

<https://online.iitkgp.ac.in/blog/ai-ml-engineer-salary-india>

Instahyre AI/ML Salary Breakdown (May 2026)

<https://resources.instahyre.com/blog/ai-engineer-salary-in-india/>

ClarUP — AI Engineer Salary + Sarvam/Krutrim data

<https://www.clarup.com/blog/ai-engineer-salary-in-india-2026>

Naukri — AIML Jobs India (live)

<https://www.naukri.com/aiml-jobs>

Scaler AI/ML Salary Complete Guide 2026

<https://www.scaler.com/topics/ai-ml-engineer-salary-complete-guide/>

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Agent Engineer

Tool orchestration · Memory · MCP

₹22–50 LPA

Very High

R3

Phase 3 — Agents & Automation

Phase 5 — Production

W02

W05

W06

W09

W10

W11

12-WEEK ROADMAP → AGENT ENGINEER		
WEEK	TOPIC	HOW IT BUILDS THIS ROLE
W02	Tool Calling + Structured Outputs	Tool/function schema definition, Zod validation, LLM-as-judge. The foundation of every agent's interface with ...
W05	Agent Design Patterns	ReAct pattern, memory architectures (in-context/Redis/episodic), multi-agent supervisor/ swarm. This week IS th...
W06	Async Agent Workflows	BullMQ workers, SSE streaming, Fly.io deployment. Production agents need async infrastructure — this is what s...
W09	Agent Observability	OpenTelemetry traces for multi-step agents, structured logging with agent step context, circuit breakers.
W10	Agent Security + Cost	Prompt injection in agentic systems (more dangerous than single-turn), guardrails, model routing for cost-effi...

SKILLS TO BUILD

→

LangGraph — stateful multi-step agent state machines with checkpointing

→

MCP (Model Context Protocol) — Anthropic's tool interface standard

→

Agent memory — in-context window management, Redis episodic, Supabase long-term

→

Tool schema design — precise function signatures that reduce hallucination

→

Multi-agent patterns — supervisor, swarm, pipeline, debate architectures

→

Agent testing — deterministic eval harnesses for non-deterministic agents

PORTFOLIO PROJECTS

P1

Compliance Sentinel Agent

LangGraph multi-step agent — highest signal for Agent Engineer roles

P2

Autonomous Code Reviewer

4-agent debate + LLM-as-judge — demonstrates multi-agent orchestration

P4

Recruiting Swarm

NER + vector scoring + calendar API — demonstrates external tool integration

OSS CONTRIBUTIONS

○

LangGraph (langchain-ai/langgraph)

○

CrewAI (crewAIInc/crewAI)

○

OpenAI Swarm (openai/swarm)

HIRING SIGNAL

Agent Engineers who understand MCP and can demonstrate multi-agent orchestration with real tool integrations (GitHub, Calendar, Slack) are the #1 most searched AI role on AngelList India in 2026.

DEMAND SIGNAL

Top 1% employable: LangGraph + multi-agent + deployed system = strongest 2026 signal

MARKET INTELLIGENCE — INDIA 2026			
SALARY RANGES		MARKET SIGNALS	
Fresher	₹12–20 LPA (junior agentic AI developer)	Growth	Role category under 2 years old — scarcity premium is at peak right now
Mid (3–7y)	₹25–55 LPA	Hirers	AI-native startups, GCCs, fintechs (Razorpay, CRED), en...
Senior	₹55–90 LPA+ (senior agentic AI architect)	Cities	Remote-first role — Bengaluru/ Hyderabad preferred but n
Remote/ US	Agentic AI skills: 40–50% salary premium over regular ML engineers	Jobs	Agentic AI roles growing 340% YoY on LinkedIn India (Li
		Gap	Most companies promoting GenAI engineers into agent rol
RESEARCH SOURCES & LIVE JOB LINKS			
BuildFastWithAI — Agentic AI Salary India 2026 https://www.buildfastwithai.com/blogs/ai-jobs-india-salary-2026			
MeriShiksha AI Jobs Salary Guide 2026 https://www.merishiksha.org/blogs/ai-jobs-salary-india-2026			
Instahyre AI/ML Salary Breakdown https://resources.instahyre.com/blog/ai-engineer-salary-in-india/			
Wellfound — Agent AI Jobs India (live) https://wellfound.com/jobs			
LangGraph Docs — MCP Integration https://langchain-ai.github.io/langgraph/concepts/			

R4

Voice AI Engineer

STT · TTS · Multimodal systems

₹18–40 LPA

Growing Fast

Phase 1 — Foundations

Phase 3 — Agents

Phase 4 — Full-Stack

W01

W02

W05

W06

W07

W11

12-WEEK ROADMAP → VOICE AI ENGINEER

WEEK	TOPIC	HOW IT BUILDS THIS ROLE
W01–W02	LLM + Streaming Foundations	Streaming LLM responses (critical for real-time voice), token economics (latency matters more in voice), multi...
W05	Agent Design for Voice	Tool calling patterns map directly to voice assistant intent routing. ReAct = voice agent's reasoning loop.
W06	Async + Real-Time Pipelines	Server-Sent Events, BullMQ, WebSockets. Voice AI requires sub-200ms latency — async infrastructure is the bott...
W07	Full-Stack Voice Integration	Next.js streaming + Web Audio API + microphone capture. Build the voice UI layer on top of the LLM backend.
W11	Capstone: Voice AI Product	Build a voice AI product using IntelliForge AwaazOS or Sarvam.ai STT/TTS stack. The @intelliforge/sarvam packa...

SKILLS TO BUILD

→ Whisper / Sarvam.ai STT — speech-to-text with language support (Hindi, Telugu, Kannada)

→ ElevenLabs / Sarvam.ai TTS — text-to-speech with natural prosody

→ Web Audio API + WebSocket — real-time audio capture and streaming

→ Voice Activity Detection (VAD) — silence detection, turn-taking

→ LLM streaming — essential for voice (can't wait for full response)

→ IntelliForge @intelliforge/sarvam package — STT/TTS integration for Indic languages

PORTFOLIO PROJECTS

W06 + W07 combined

Voice AI Chatbot

WebSocket audio → STT (Sarvam.ai/ Whisper) → LLM → TTS → audio stream. Real-time voice pipeline.

PI variant

Voice Compliance Agent

Compliance Sentinel with voice reporting — natural extension of PI with voice output layer.

W11 capstone

AwaazOS-powered App

IntelliForge's @intelliforge/sarvam integration for Hindi/ Kannada/Telugu voice AI.

OSS CONTRIBUTIONS

Whisper (openai/whisper)

Vercel AI SDK (vercel/ai) — streaming

Trigger.dev (triggerdotdev/trigger.dev)

HIRING SIGNAL

Voice AI Engineers with Indic language support (Hindi, Telugu, Tamil) are in severe shortage. The Bharat AI market demands regional language voice — this is a 3-year window of opportunity.

DEMAND SIGNAL

Sarvam AI Bulbul TTS + Saarika STT power majority of Indian voice AI ecosystem

MARKET INTELLIGENCE — INDIA 2026

SALARY RANGES		MARKET SIGNALS	
Fresher	₹12–22 LPA (Indic language voice specialist premium)	Growth	Sarvam AI Series B + Krutrim ₹2,000 Cr+ 2025 raise — Indic AI investment surging
		Hirers	Sarvam AI (₹20–75 LPA), Krutrim, Bolna, Gnani, Yellow.a...
Mid (3–7y)	₹25–50 LPA	Cities	Bengaluru-first; Sarvam, Krutrim both Bengaluru-based;
Senior	₹50–90 LPA (senior ML engineer serving TTS/ASR at scale ≈ ₹45 LPA fully loaded)	Jobs	24+ open roles at Sarvam alone (June 2026); voice AI pl
		Gap	Engineers with Indic tokenisation + voice pipeline expe
Remote/ US	Self-hosted voice AI stack: 1 senior ML + 1 backend + 0.5 SRE ≈ ₹1.1 Cr/yr team cost		

RESEARCH SOURCES & LIVE JOB LINKS

Sarvam AI Careers — Open Roles June 2026

<https://www.sarvam.ai/careers>

Open-Source Voice AI India 2026 — Caller Digital

<https://www.caller.digital/blog/open-source-voice-ai-india-sarvam-ai4bharat-bhasini-2026>

Top 10 Voice AI Agents India 2026 — Caller Digital

<https://caller.digital/blog/top-10-voice-ai-agents-india-2026>

ClarUP — Sarvam + Krutrim salary data 2026

<https://www.clarup.com/blog/ai-engineer-salary-in-india-2026>

AI4Bharat — Indic ASR/TTS open source

<https://ai4bharat.iitm.ac.in/>

R5

AI Product Engineer

System design · UX · Scalability

₹25–60 LPA

High

Phase 4 — Full-Stack AI

Phase 5 — Production

Phase 6 — Capstone

W01

W02

W07

W08

W09

W10

W11

W12

12-WEEK ROADMAP → AI PRODUCT ENGINEER

WEEK	TOPIC	HOW IT BUILDS THIS ROLE
W07	Next.js 14 + AI UX	App Router, streaming UIs, Suspense, Clerk auth. AI Product Engineers need to ship the full product — frontend...
W08	Data Layer + Monetisation	Prisma schema for AI products, Razorpay subscriptions, usage-based billing, RLS. Product Engineers must unders...
W09	Production Reliability	Vercel + Fly.io deploy, Sentry, health checks, runbooks. Product Engineers own uptime.
W10	Cost + Scale Architecture	Semantic caching, model routing, cost dashboards. P5 Cost-Aware Router is a product architecture exercise.
W11–W12	Capstone + GTM	Full product build + LinkedIn positioning + portfolio. AI Product Engineers need strong personal brand to comm...

SKILLS TO BUILD

→ Next.js 14 App Router — server components, streaming, suspense boundaries

→ Vercel AI SDK — useChat, useCompletion, generative UI patterns

→ Clerk multi-tenant auth — org-scoped data isolation with RLS

→ Razorpay subscriptions — usage-based billing in paise, webhook handlers

→ System design for AI — cost estimation, latency budgeting, fallback patterns

→ AI UX patterns — loading states, streaming text, error boundaries, feedback loops

PORTFOLIO PROJECTS

P4 Recruiting Swarm

End-to-end SaaS with NER + agents + calendar — full product engineering

P5 Cost-Aware Agent Router

Architecture + observability + cost control — product infra thinking

W11 capstone AI SaaS Product

Complete product: auth, payments, AI pipeline, deployment, runbook

OSS CONTRIBUTIONS

○ Vercel AI SDK (vercel/ai)

○ Trigger.dev (triggerdotdev/trigger.dev)

○ PDFForge (intelliforge-ai/pdfforge)

HIRING SIGNAL

AI Product Engineers who can design, build, and ship a complete AI SaaS with auth + payments + observability are 10× harder to find than pure AI researchers. This is the highest-paid generalist role in Indian AI.

DEMAND SIGNAL

LLM + MLOps + full-stack combo: 30–50% above equivalent pure software engineer

MARKET INTELLIGENCE — INDIA 2026

SALARY RANGES		MARKET SIGNALS	
Fresher	₹12–25 LPA (full-stack + AI combo)	Growth	81% of VC funding in India Q1 2026 went to AI startups (NASSCOM) — product engineers in demand
Mid (3–7y)	₹30–60 LPA	Hirers	AI-first startups, fintechs (CRED ₹1 Cr+, Razorpay, Pho...
Senior	₹60–1 Cr+ (VP AI Engineering at funded startups: ₹1.5–2.5 Cr cash + equity)	Cities	Bengaluru + Mumbai for product companies; Hyderabad GCC
		Jobs	340% increase in AI-specific job postings vs 2025 (Link)
Remote/US	AI Product Engineers at US product companies from India: ₹80–1.2 Cr LPA	Gap	Engineers who understand AI cost economics, streaming U

RESEARCH SOURCES & LIVE JOB LINKS

Taggd — GenAI + AI Product Engineer Salary 2026

<https://taggd.in/blogs/ai-engineer-salary/>

Instahyre — Staff/Principal AI Engineer Salary

<https://resources.instahyre.com/blog/ai-engineer-salary-in-india/>

MeriShiksha — 4,00,000+ AI Jobs India June 2026

<https://www.merishiksha.org/blogs/ai-jobs-salary-india-2026>

Wellfound — AI Product Engineer Jobs India

<https://wellfound.com/jobs>

LinkedIn India — AI Job Postings Growth 2026

<https://www.linkedin.com/jobs/ai-engineer-jobs-india/>

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